

MEDILAB

Specimen Acceptance, Recollection & Quality Exceptions Guide

Knowledge Base Category: Processes

Document Type	Customer-facing process / policy guidance
Intended Use	RAG knowledge retrieval and website reference
Version	1.0 - Assessment Dataset
Clinical Boundary	Operational information only; not clinical advice

Customer-facing explanation of why a laboratory specimen may be rejected or require recollection and how the issue is handled.

Quick Reference

Use this document for	Do not use this document for
Stable customer-service process, policy, preparation, FAQ, and operational guidance.	Live prices, slot availability, booking status, patient-specific clinical interpretation, diagnosis, or medication advice.

1. Why Specimen Quality Matters

Laboratory testing depends on receiving the correct specimen, collected from the correct patient, in the correct container, with enough material and appropriate handling. If these conditions are not met, the laboratory may be unable to produce a reliable report.

A recollection request is a quality-control action. It should not be described as evidence that the patient's health status is abnormal.

2. Identity or Label Mismatch

A specimen may be rejected when the identifiers on the specimen do not match the verified patient or order, required identifiers are missing, or there is uncertainty about who the specimen belongs to.

Staff must not correct an identity mismatch by guessing. When identity cannot be established reliably, recollection is the safe process.

3. Incorrect or Unapproved Container

Different tests may require different specimen containers or additives. A specimen collected in an unapproved container may not be suitable for the ordered test.

Customer service should verify the test-specific collection requirement or escalate to the laboratory rather than recommending transfer between containers.

4. Insufficient Quantity

If the specimen volume is below the amount required for the ordered testing, the laboratory may be unable to complete all requested tests. Recollection may be requested when there is not enough specimen for a valid analytical process.

The required volume is test-specific and should come from the trusted test instruction or laboratory SOP.

5. Clotted, Hemolyzed, Contaminated, or Damaged Specimens

Some tests require a specimen in a particular physical condition. Visible clotting in an anticoagulated sample, significant hemolysis, contamination, leakage, or damaged containers may make a specimen unsuitable for one or more tests.

Suitability decisions are made by laboratory rules and technical review. Customer service should communicate the status and next step, not make the acceptance decision independently.

6. Transport Time and Temperature

Certain specimens must reach the laboratory within a defined time or remain within an approved temperature range. A delay, uncontrolled storage, or transport problem may require recollection when specimen integrity cannot be assured.

Home and branch collection workflows should use approved transport procedures. Detailed internal transport SOPs are maintained separately from this customer-facing guide.

7. Patient Preparation Issue

A specimen may need recollection when a test requires a preparation condition that was not met, such as a required fasting period or defined collection time. The decision depends on the specific test requirement.

If a deviation is identified before collection, the patient should tell the collection team so the test can be handled correctly before a specimen is drawn.

8. Recollection Process

When recollection is required, MediLab should explain the reason in clear operational language, provide any required preparation instruction, and help arrange an eligible branch or home collection option.

The new specimen is treated as a new collection event but remains linked to the relevant order or service process according to system rules.

9. Fees and Service Errors

If recollection is caused by a documented MediLab collection or handling error, the applicable service-fee treatment follows the current billing policy. If the issue is caused by a patient preparation problem or an external order requirement, different billing rules may apply.

Customer service should not promise a refund or charge waiver until the billing rule or authorized adjustment is confirmed.

10. Escalation

Escalate unclear rejection reasons, repeated recollection, disputed identity issues, suspected privacy incidents, or any case where the patient requests clinical interpretation of why the specimen was unsuitable.

Document Control Notes

- This is a fictional MediLab assessment document designed to resemble real diagnostic-laboratory customer-service documentation.
- If a live structured record conflicts with this document, the structured record controls for price, availability, booking, status, and test-specific catalog values.
- If a future policy changes, update the KnowledgeDocument version and reindex the RAG corpus so stale chunks are removed.
- Customer service must not use this document to diagnose, clinically interpret results, prescribe medication, or recommend medically necessary tests from symptoms.